

Summary Post

by [Abdulla Husain Salem Hadna Almessabi](#) - Wednesday, 17 December 2025, 7:40 PM

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This discussion has been an in-depth examination of the ethical issues of computing and data professionals, which goes beyond the easy ban on data fabrication to the more difficult and less obvious issues of professional practice.

The main lesson learnt is that the responsibility of a professional is much further than a technical service to a client. The duty to the public interest and the good of society is the paramount one, as laid out in major codes of ethics such as the ACM Code (2018) and the BCS Code of Conduct (2021). This implies that where an issue such as that of Abi is involved, where there is an element of the health of the people, the ethical imperative that prevents harm and demands transparency takes precedence over any business interest and pressure to provide positive outcomes.

One of the lessons of the discussion was the breakdown of the unethical practices, which are specific and put integrity at risk. P-hacking, cherry-picking, or HARKing (Hypothesising After the Results are Known) to present data selectively was a unanimously disapproved activity (Ioannidis, 2005; Rubin, 2017). Such traditions pervert the scientific procedure internally by basing valid information on a false story, which is worse than outright falsification since it is less noticeable.

Moreover, it has been explained during the discussion that professional responsibility does not cease with the provision of a report. Care is responsible for the manner of results reporting and contextualisation. The professional should rely on his skills to point out the strength of primary results and the weakness of exploratory studies to avoid misunderstandings (Greenland et al., 2016). Negligence in this responsibility, particularly in matters relating to safety, can be very destructive, undermining the confidence of people in science and may result in legal actions in cases of professional negligence.

Lastly, I came to know that there is a structured action framework that aids in ethical practice. In the dilemma, this is not an inactive submission or quiet resignation. It entails principled reporting, institutional support by ethics panels, and responsible whistleblowing to the regulatory bodies as the final resort when harm to the institution is imminent. It is a multi-step process based on professional codes that would give a clear idea of how to maintain integrity in a pressurised situation.

References

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